

SUFFER NO MORE

TOPIC: SUFFERING

Q: What is suffering?

A: The dictionary defines suffering as a state of undergoing pain, distress, misery, and hardship. It's the state that makes one suffer from some kind of agony. The word 'Suffering' is derived from the root word sub – meaning 'below' and ferre meaning 'bear'. When we are unable to bear a certain distress we start to suffer.

*Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 1*

Q: Is suffering the same as pain?

A: Most people confuse pain with suffering. They do not realize that the pain experienced in the brain is a little different from the suffering that we go through. As long as we are alive, we will experience physical pain. It is unavoidable. But despite physical pain, we can choose not to suffer.

*Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 3*

Q: What are the types of suffering a human being experiences?

A: Suffering can be that of the body due to physical pain, that of the mind, due to emotional pain and that of the ego due to the ignorance of who we truly are.

*Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 7*

Q: How does physical pain cause suffering?

A: When we prick our finger, the tissue in the body gets damaged. The skin registers this through pain receptors that are part of neurons or nerve cells. The pain signal is then passed on through an electric signal through a channel to the spinal cord. Thereafter, the pain signal is passed on to the brain, which relays it to the part of the body that feels the pain.

*Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 4*

Q: What does suffering do to us?

A: Suffering robs us of our happiness. It makes our heart sink and our body shiver. What does suffering do? It steals the smile from our face and the laughter from our lives. It makes us feel that our life is somehow, not worth living. It makes us restless, lazy, and lethargic, and ultimately can even lead us to suicidal thoughts.

*Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 8*

Q: Can we overcome physical pain and stop suffering from it?

A: Once upon a time, suffering due to physical pain wasn't within our control, but today, there are remedies for every kind of physical pain. We don't need to suffer anymore. Simple pain can be overcome with simple painkillers. We can cut the pain in the brain and we don't have to suffer.

*Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 6*

Q: Is suffering truly unavoidable in life?

A: Suffering is a choice. We don't need to suffer. This may come as a surprise but it is the Truth. We choose to suffer due to ignorance that drowns us in misery and sorrow. We live in this ignorance, this myth, that suffering is an unavoidable part of life.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Preface | Page Preface

Q: What is the root cause of all suffering?

A: Whether it is physical pain or emotional stress, whether it is because of fear, worry, anxiety or anger, or due to disappointments caused because of unfulfilled desires – all suffering is born out of ignorance. Ignorance makes us greedy, just as it makes us attached to people and things. If the cause of suffering was thus to be defined in one word, that one word would be 'ignorance'.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 28

Q: Why do we suffer from emotional pain more than physical pain?

A: Far more than pain in the brain is the suffering caused by other causes and thus we must move beyond the belief that suffering is mostly caused by pain that is physical. We suffer more due to negative emotions that cause us distress, unhappiness, frustration, agony, and disappointment. Emotional pain can have far-reaching effects when compared to that of pain of the body.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 8

Q: Why do we compare ourselves with others and suffer?

A: We suffer tremendously because the fire of jealousy kept burning our happiness. When we don't count our blessings, we continue to suffer though we don't need to. We should always count our blessings for we have plenty when compared to the less fortunate ones. If we are grateful, we can escape from suffering regardless of the situation we may be in.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 10

Q: Is suffering a universal experience?

A: From birth to death, we experience joy and sorrow as if it is a see-saw, each taking turns coming up and down in our lives. There are moments of tremendous joy and celebration, just as there are moments of misery, sorrow, and pain. Nobody can escape pain. Everybody alive is gifted with this inevitable experience. While none of us wants to be miserable and nobody enjoys pain, whether or not to suffer by it, is in our hands.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 16

Q: What is the pleasure-pain principle and how does it relate to suffering?

A: The whole world lives by a principle called the pleasure-pain principle. This principle states that every human being wants to be happy, just as no human being wants to be unhappy. It is natural for people to seek pleasure, just as it is natural to shun pain. Whether it is a young child or an aged adult – everyone likes to be glad, not sad.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 12

Q: What is the connection between desire and suffering?

A: It is this craving for happiness that causes us to desire again and again. Unfortunately, all our desires are not fulfilled and every unfulfilled desire leads to disappointment and misery. If there was no desire, there are chances that we would not be miserable, but we create sorrow for ourselves by this constant craving.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: *Why Do We Suffer?* | Page 22

Q: How does self-inflicted suffering happen?

A: Our body and mind are actually within our control and whether we suffer or not, is most often a choice. Sometimes one may suffer due to the food one eats. Sometimes we suffer because we haven't slept enough. Our passion to watch a movie keeps us awake all night long – only to suffer the next few days.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: *What Is Suffering?* | Page 11

Q: How can we truly end suffering?

A: There is a way to Suffer No More if we systematically understand the cause and diligently work on eradicating the ignorance and realizing the Truth. We can be truly happy – rejoicing in every moment of life. To overcome suffering one must understand what it is and how it is caused. We may have pain but we can choose to Suffer No More!

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: *Why Do We Suffer?* | Page 27

TOPIC: IGNORANCE AND IDENTITY

Q: Why does ignorance cause suffering?

A: Why is it that most of humanity suffers? No doubt we have a body that experiences pain and we seem to have a mind that languishes in misery, but we don't need to suffer. Because we are ignorant of the fact that we are not the body or mind, we suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: *Overcoming Ignorance* | Page 50

Q: Who are we truly — body, mind, or something else?

A: I suffer because I think I am the body, mind, and ego. When the body suffers, I experience the suffering. When the mind is distressed, I feel the agony. To top it all, my ego makes me miserable because of its 'I' ness and 'MY' ness. If only I realize the Truth of who I actually am, all suffering can cease.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: *What Is Suffering?* | Page 13

Q: Who actually suffers — the body, the mind, or the ego?

A: We are prisoners in a cage created by the ego, the mind, and the body. We are the ones who experience the misery because we live as an embodied Soul not realizing our true identity. The body experiences pain but we don't need to suffer. If we transcend ME – 'Mind + Ego' then we are free from the mind and the ego. Till we are liberated from this prison – we will continue to suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: *Why Do We Suffer?* | Page 20

Q: What does it mean that the mind is an illusion?

A: This may sound strange but it is true. We all talk of a mind that suffers but in reality the mind is an illusion. It does not exist. The moment we overcome this ignorance we become intelligent observers and Suffer No More. There is no end to defining the mind and if you tell somebody that they have no mind they will think that you have lost yours.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 56

Q: How do spiritual saints overcome suffering?

A: If we analyze the lives of spiritual saints, those who have realized the Truth, they don't suffer. Their body experiences pain but they are very clear that they do not experience the suffering. They use techniques like silence and meditation and eliminate all suffering of the mind. Because they are conscious of the Truth, they transcend the ego and experience peace, joy, and bliss.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 60

Q: How does the ego cause suffering?

The ego continues to make us suffer as it lives in a world of 'I' ness, 'My' ness and 'Mine' ness. The constant 'I' of the ego makes it suffer due to expectations that are born out of ignorance. This is my house, my car, my spouse. And everything else that the ego thinks is mine creates attachments that make us suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 59

Q: What does it mean to be an observer of life?

A: The only way to realize the Truth and eliminate all suffering is to overcome the ignorance that we are an ego-mind-body complex that lives on earth to suffer until death. If only we view this world as a theatre, a show where we come and go, we can live with peace, joy, and bliss. We are observers who have donned the clothes of the actors during the 'life-show'. This realization will liberate us from all suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 62

Q: How does mistaken identity lead to suffering?

A: Don't we all suffer because of mistaken identity, thinking that we are the ego, mind and body? If we overcome the ignorance and realize that we are not the ego, mind and body, then we can truly enjoy the show and rejoice with happiness. The cosmic illusion makes us believe that we are the body. We suffer because instead of thinking that we have a body, the illusion makes us believe that we are the body.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 6: Rejoice – Enjoy the Show | Page 68

Q: What are the three categories of people based on how they suffer?

A: People can be divided into three categories: the first thinks they are the body and mind and suffer both physical and emotional pain. The second thinks they are only the mind — they fight physical pain but suffer emotionally. Only a few fortunate people live as embodied Souls — they realize they are not the body or mind, and live as observers who do not suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 4: Who Suffers? | Page 44

Q: Can we stop suffering by overcoming the body-mind complex?

A: If we realize that we are not the body and mind, then even the suffering that comes to us won't make us miserable. Suppose, you throw some dirty coins at me and I refuse to accept them – they lie all around – who do they belong to? They still belong to you. I have not accepted them. Suffering becomes ours only if we accept it. If we refuse to accept suffering we can live blissfully.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 101

Q: Why does Maya (cosmic illusion) cause suffering?

A: One major reason we suffer is because of our ignorance of the Truth, because of Maya – the cosmic illusion. We human beings are ignorant of who we truly are and most of our suffering is caused because of living a life of mistaken identity. Ignorance of the Truth is the biggest reason for suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 24

Q: How can we find and eliminate the mind to stop suffering?

A: To overcome this ignorance, one must try to find the mind. It is strange but we can find our nose, our ears, our heart, and even our brain but we can't find our mind. Just like walking is the activity of the legs, and talking of the mouth, stress, worry, and anxiety are the functions of the brain through thoughts. Just stop the activity and you can end your suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 55

Q: What role does intellect play in overcoming suffering?

A: Our mind is a rascal. There is another part of our mind called the intellect. Separate the two. The mind thinks and makes us suffer. The intellect discriminates and makes us happy. We must put our intellect in charge of our life. We must filter every thought so that we can choose our thoughts, keeping the happy ones, and throwing away the miserable ones.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 97

Q: How does a Yogi or enlightened person deal with bodily suffering?

A: I met a Yogi in a monastery in the Himalayas who was suffering from cancer in its final stage. However, there was not a glimpse of suffering on his face. He said, 'Oh yes, this body is afflicted with cancer but that is fine. Whenever the pain is unbearable they give me some medicine. I do not let it make me suffer. If the body likes to suffer it can. But I don't want to suffer its suffering. So I am calm, peaceful and blissful in meditation.'

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 102

Q: What is the ultimate realization that ends all suffering?

By overcoming the ignorance that we are not the ego, the mind or the body we will Suffer No More. The moment we overcome this ignorance, we overcome suffering. We can enjoy our original state of peace if we use our intellect to control our brain activity and not let our thoughts rumble and mumble like a monkey that creates anxiety through its desires, cravings and negative thoughts.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 58

TOPIC: MESSENGER OF MISERY

Q: What are the messengers of misery?

A: Most suffering is actually caused by the messengers of misery. The messengers don't hesitate to bring bad news along with misery, sorrow, and unhappiness. These create pain, distress, and agony and become part of our life. They fill our life with negative emotions that spread poison within. These messengers steal our happiness. They are the cause of our suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 29

Q: What is fear and how does it cause suffering?

A: Fear is an emotion that magnifies perceived dangers creating worry and stress. Our dangers are not as numerous as our fears. FEAR is False Expectations Appearing Real. By creating false alarms in our life, fear is like an alarm clock that keeps on reminding us to be miserable because of perceived dangers which may never ever happen. If we want to eliminate suffering from our life – we must first eliminate fear.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 30

Q: How does worry make us suffer?

A: Worry is living in the future, which in reality doesn't exist. While we can't live in the future, we can definitely lose our present moment of peace and joy by letting worry be a messenger of misery. We don't need to worry. It is a choice. More people suffer from worry than they do from many dreaded diseases. If you want to Suffer No More kill worry before worry kills you.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 31

Q: How does anger burn away our peace?

A: There is a terror within that burns away our peace and joy. It is called Anger. It is a dreadful messenger of misery. While it tries to spit fire on others – we don't realize that it first burns the very hand that is trying to throw the fire on somebody else. We have certain expectations and because our expectations are not met – we are up with anger and we suffer. We must burn anger before anger burns us.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 34

Q: What is the effect of jealousy on happiness?

A: A common thief of happiness is Jealousy. It enters our life from the back door and without us realizing, it fills our life with misery. What does it do? It makes us envious of somebody else's achievement, advantages or possessions and we regret our own inadequacy, thus creating suffering. Every time jealousy enters, joy exits. Only one can be in our life at any given point of time.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 35

Q: How does regret become a source of suffering?

A: Something happened yesterday, last week, even last year but they haven't forgotten it. Don't such regrets make us miserable? By making us regret a miserable past, regret robs us of a beautiful present. Can we do something about what is over? Most likely not. But living with regret carries the misery of yesterday and destroys the happiness of today. If we want to live without suffering we must stop living with regret.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 32

Q: What is the role of greed in causing misery?

An intense and selfish desire to own something which is beyond our need can be easily understood as Greed. While we all have needs, we suffer because we let greed take charge of our life. A greedy man says, 'This is mine...but what is yours should also be mine.' When greed becomes a habit – it makes suffering our best friend as they both go hand in hand together.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 37

Q: How does guilt keep us imprisoned in suffering?

A: What does guilt do? It makes us feel guilty about something we have done, whether or not we have made good for it. Guilt doesn't forget what we did. It keeps replaying our deeds so that this repetition makes us miserable. Guilt is certainly not the solution to our suffering. It only adds fuel to the fire and makes our misery rage with agony. We should eliminate guilt if we want to be happy.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 38

Q: Why does hate destroy peace and joy?

A: When we have an intense dislike for somebody or something, we suffer. This is Hate. This messenger brings misery whenever it strikes. I hate my job. I hate my boss. I hate my family — all this makes you hate your life. Any kind of hate causes suffering. It is a negative emotion and spreads poison. The only way to eliminate this suffering of hate is to replace it with love. Just as love brings with it the blessing of peace and joy, hate destroys it.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 39

Q: How does anxiety steal our present moment?

A: Anxiety is the expertise developed by people that makes them shuttle between the past and the future, guaranteeing misery. They shuttle from a past that is gone to a tomorrow not yet born and create a ton of misery. The only way to be happy is to be happy in the now. But anxiety is an expert thief of the present moment. This messenger of misery doesn't let us remain in the moment.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 33

Q: Why does depression cause so much suffering?

A: Depression creeps into our life philosophy and corrodes our life. What does depression do? Slowly but steadily, it eats away our cheerfulness that would otherwise make us happy and instead, makes us constantly miserable. The world today dreads depression and considers it to be one of the deadliest diseases.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 41

Q: What is the law of cause and effect in relation to suffering?

A: If we notice, the Law of Cause and Effect kicks in here. Where the cause is a messenger of misery, the effect is suffering. Why do we suffer? The cause is these miserable emotions. If only we eliminate the cause, we can also eliminate the effect and Suffer No More!

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 42

Q: How does revenge create misery?

A: While we may take revenge on somebody to avenge the wrong done, we don't realize that we create tremendous misery in our life. What does revenge do? It motivates us to actions that will make us unhappy. By doing wrong to others, how can we create joy in our life? If we let this negative feeling of revenge reside in us, we only let this messenger of misery lead us to negative poison.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 40

Q: How can we protect ourselves from all the messengers of misery?

A: We must be very careful of these messengers of negativity. They fill our life with misery. And if we want to Suffer No More, we must first beware of these. The only way to eliminate them is to replace the negative emotions with positive ones. We must be cautious of all these messengers of misery if we want to Suffer No More.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 42

Q: How does ingratitude (ungratefulness) cause suffering?

A: Scott's mother analysed that his misery was because of the messenger ungratefulness. Even if somebody did something for Scott, he never said 'thank you'. His mother advised him to become grateful for everything and eventually, Scott became a happy man. Gratitude is the antidote to the misery that ungratefulness creates in our lives.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 42

TOPIC: ACCEPTANCE AND SURRENDER

Q: What is the Art of Acceptance?

A: To eliminate suffering from life, we must adopt a life philosophy that is based on a key principle — the Art of Acceptance. What is the major reason for people to suffer? They live in yesterday regretting what has happened in the past. We can't change the past. If we don't accept it, we must still suffer. Nobody can change a dot of the past. The past is the past. It is etched in stone.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 72

Q: Why is it foolish to be unhappy about the past?

A: Can you change the past? Something happened last year, last week or even yesterday. Can anybody on earth undo it? Even the president of the United States or the richest man on earth

can't change a dot of the past. The past is the past. It is etched in stone. It cannot be undone. If the past cannot be undone, then isn't it foolish to be unhappy thinking of the past?

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 72

Q: How can we stop living with regrets?

A: We must learn to eliminate our regrets and both forgive and forget the past. Some people rehearse whatever happened in their lives because they are unable to forgive people. They nurse and curse their wound. We must learn the art of acceptance. The art of acceptance acts as a filter that blocks unpleasant experiences from being recorded in our memory only to be replayed later to make us suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 75

Q: What does it mean to live in surrender?

A: Living in surrender means living with faith and trust. It is not hoping for something to happen but accepting whatever happens as something that is the Divine Will and what is good for us. We need to realize that there is a cosmic factor that determines the result of our efforts, action, and equipment. We must do our best. That's what we can do. We must surrender and trust that the Cosmic Power will take care of the rest.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 84

Q: How does worrying about tomorrow cause suffering?

A: Our biggest anxiety is about tomorrow. Why do they say tomorrow never comes? Because that is the fact. Today is the tomorrow you worried about yesterday. And when the tomorrow that you are worrying about today comes, it will be today not tomorrow. Essentially, tomorrow can never come. Only when it becomes today, we can experience that tomorrow that we are worrying about.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 82

Q: What is the only way to destroy the misery of tomorrow?

A: If most of our suffering is not about this moment but rather about next week, next month or next year, how can we eradicate such suffering? The only way to destroy such misery is by living in surrender. We must develop a habit of being conscious of the now. In reality, only now exists. Nothing beyond this moment exists. That is the Truth.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 83

Q: How does faith help us surrender and stop suffering?

Living in surrender means doing away with hopes and wishes. We lack FAITH – Full Assurance in the Heart, and TRUST - Total Reliance Unconditional Surrender to The Almighty and are unable to surrender. We want to control the results of tomorrow though we know we can't. If only we learn to accept rather than wonder, and replace hope with surrender, we can be happy.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 85

Q: How does accepting the Divine Will lead to peace?

A: Those who learn the Art of Acceptance, enjoy the present moment without clinging to the past. They accept the past as the Divine Will and move on. Living in surrender means accepting whatever happens as something that is the Divine Will and what is good for us. Those who surrender to the Divine Will live a life of tranquility.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 78

Q: Can we change the past, and why should we stop trying to?

A: You have a choice to curse what happened and cry over the past or reverse what happened and live life like a blast. You have a beautiful present that you can definitely spoil by crying and living in the past. Nobody can go back to yesterday. But you insist on living in the past — recalling all your miseries and suffering in the present moment. What good is that?

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 77

Q: What is the cosmic factor that shapes our life beyond our control?

A: We don't realize that there is another factor, a cosmic factor that is beyond our control. It can change the result that we expect, despite our best efforts. When such a factor exists, then it is best to surrender to such a power, such a force. Those who live and suffer have to learn the art of surrendering to the Divine. If only we learn to accept rather than wonder, and replace hope with surrender, we can be happy.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 86

Q: How does the art of acceptance filter painful memories?

A: The art of acceptance acts as a filter that blocks unpleasant experiences from being recorded in our memory only to be replayed later to make us suffer. We must forget about the miseries that we experienced. If we don't let go of the suffering that should have died long back, it will come alive again to haunt us. There is no new misery. It's just that we are not letting go of the old pain.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 75

Q: Is surrender a sign of weakness or wisdom?

A: Living in surrender means doing away with hopes and wishes. These actually make us suffer. When we constantly hope and wish for something we are already planting a seed of disappointment which is sure to make us miserable. Don't we realize that we can only do our best but we cannot control the rest? Surrender is wisdom — it is total trust in the Divine.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 85

Q: What happens when we live consciously in the present moment?

A: When we surrender to the present moment and are conscious that there is nothing beyond, we can live with peace and bliss. There is no need to suffer. It is only when we don't surrender to the now and lose consciousness of this moment that we slip into a future that is full of anxiety, worry, and stress. This causes us to suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 83

Q: How do forgiveness and forgetting help end suffering?

A: We must learn to eliminate our regrets and both forgive and forget the past. Some people try to forget the past. But they nurse and curse their wound. They suffer every new day of life. Isn't it time to reverse the situation? Isn't it time to eliminate sorrow and misery? Unless we really enjoy suffering, we must learn to accept the past and move on.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 74

Q: What is the key message of the Art of Acceptance?

A: You will suffer if you choose to live in the Past. Those who look back, their joy never Lasts. If you want to do away with misery and Regret, then live with Acceptance, Forgive and Forget. If we want to Suffer No More, we must develop the Art of Acceptance. Accept whatever has happened as the Divine Will and live joyously.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 7: The Art of Acceptance | Page 80

TOPIC: JOY, PEACE & LIVING IN THE NOW

Q: How can we live in joy and peace all the time?

A: You can choose to be happy for the rest of your life – no matter what. No matter if there is physical pain or mental torture, if you learn not to suffer, you can eliminate misery from your life. This is possible if you make a commitment to be happy. If you resolve to live in bliss, you can. It has to be a conscious decision.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 89

Q: How do we stop the mind from dragging us into the past?

A: Live in the present moment. Enjoy the now. Celebrate today. If your mind tries to jump like a monkey to recall the regrets of yesterday – shoot it down. If the rascal tries to fear tomorrow – kill it. Kill your mind before your mind kills you. Eliminate suffering before it strikes and you can dance through life. Smile, laugh, and enjoy the present moment.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 90

Q: Is happiness truly a choice?

A: Suffering is a choice. If you really enjoy it, then good luck. If you love to suffer then nobody can help you. To be happy is a choice, so is to be unhappy. You can choose to smile for life is just a while. We cannot control things that happen to us but we can definitely control the way we react, and be happy.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 95

Q: What does it mean to rejoice and enjoy the show of life?

A: Those who realize the Truth that they are not the body that suffers, they are not the mind that is miserable, they rejoice and enjoy every moment of life. The ones who rejoice realize that life is an illusion, just like a dream. They know that they are but actors in this cosmic drama and in the end when the curtain is drawn, everything disappears and dissolves.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 6: Rejoice – Enjoy the Show | Page 63

Q: How should we live life like a drama or show?

A: One should enjoy every moment of life, observing how wondrous this theatre of eight billion people is. How we come is predetermined. Our date of birth, our parents, our gender, our place of birth are all predefined by the producer of the show. How we live and how we act in everyday circumstances is our choice. Whether we choose to smile or stretch our misery to a mile is up to us.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 6: Rejoice – Enjoy the Show | Page 69

Q: How can we slow down the mind to reduce suffering?

A: We must slow down the mind. The mind can produce 50 thoughts a minute – a whopping 50,000 thoughts a day. It is the thoughts that make us suffer. The more the thoughts, the more the stress, the more the suffering. We must reduce our MTR – Mental Thought Rate. How do we do it? By watching the mind. Spend moments in silence. Contemplate a positive thought. We should be still until we convert the mind from a monkey to a monk.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 98

Q: Why do bad things happen to good people?

A: There is a universal law of action and reaction. As we sow, so shall we reap. If we are reaping suffering, we must have sowed it somewhere before. Maybe it's in the distant past and we must have forgotten about it. But when suffering comes, we must let it negate our past deeds gracefully without making us suffer. Eventually, the suffering will end. Rather than suffer we must celebrate that our own negative account is settled!

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 100

Q: How does a childlike attitude protect us from suffering?

A: Children are happy. They live such blissful lives. Nothing matters to them. They play, they laugh, and they scream and enjoy their life. They don't suffer till they grow up. If we remain like children, then we will ignore the suffering others pour on us. We enjoy our life in a childlike manner. Bring back the child in you who knows how to play through life.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 94

Q: What is the gift of the present moment?

A: Some people are crazy. When you give them a gift – they throw it away. I watch them throw the gift of the present moment and instead, search for garbage in the dustbin of yesterday and tomorrow. Rather than enjoying the fresh, clean blissful air of the present, they enjoy the stink of yesterday and look forward to the dirt of tomorrow. We know there is bliss in the now.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 92

Q: How do moments of joy build a joyous life?

A: Be happy moment by moment. That means be happy now. When the next moment comes, be happy in that moment. Eliminate suffering. Do you know moments create minutes? Minutes become hours and days. Days become weeks and months. Months become years and your life. If you can make your moment joyous, you can make your life joyous.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 93

Q: What role do positive affirmations play in living joyfully?

A: This is the day that God has made. I shall rejoice and be glad in it. Those who live with such positive affirmations celebrate life. They do not live in the misery of yesterday just as they refuse to suffer in the fears of tomorrow. They live life moment by moment with joy and peace. I choose to be happy today. Though the skies are cloudy and grey, no matter what comes my way, I shall be happy today.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 6: Rejoice – Enjoy the Show | Page 71

Q: How do we observe life as a drama to stop suffering?

A: You watch everything happening as an observer. Don't jump into life, watch life happen if you want to be happy. You are sitting in the theatre. You are part of the whole show but you are not acting. You are just watching. The actors may suffer on stage but you don't suffer. You observe it as a drama, a movie. We are just actors, we come and we go. There will be laughter, there will be tears, such is the 'life-show'.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 93

Q: How does attachment to outcomes cause suffering?

We are very particular about what we want when we want and how we want it. If we want a particular life partner, we become so passionate and obsessed that we blindly crave for that person. We go on worrying and lose all our peace. If we want to avoid this suffering, we should just surrender, accepting the Divine Will, trusting that whatever will happen, will happen for the good.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 8: Living in Surrender | Page 84

Q: What are the four pillars of a life free from suffering?

A: I have built my life on 4 pillars – Faith, Hope, Trust, and Enthusiasm. On top of the 4 pillars, I have laid out a table of love. I sit on this amazing table – happy and joyous with tranquillity and peace and suffering doesn't touch me. Problems are not stumbling blocks, they are stepping stones. They are not stop signs, they are guidelines. They are challenges not to make us suffer but to make us strong.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Afterword | Page 110

Q: What is the ultimate weapon to destroy suffering forever?

A: You have to always carry a weapon with you. Not a weapon to kill people or animals but the one that destroys suffering, even as suffering raises its ugly head above the surface of your life. You kill it, destroy it and eliminate it completely. This weapon is your intellect! We must put our intellect in charge of our life. This is the ultimate weapon to Suffer No More — Realization of the Truth and Liberation.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 89

TOPIC: DESIRE, ATTACHMENT AND DETACHMENT

Q: How do unfulfilled desires lead to suffering?

A: As human beings, we are inherently peaceful and blissful. But we don't remain so – we create some desire, with the hope that the fulfillment of the desire will give us happiness. It is this craving for happiness that causes us to desire again and again. Unfortunately, all our desires are not fulfilled and every unfulfilled desire leads to disappointment and misery.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: *Why Do We Suffer?* | Page 22

Q: How does attachment to loved ones cause suffering?

A: Sometimes, we become unhappy because we let others take control of our life. This is because of our attachment to those we love. We permit them to sit in the driver's seat and lead us to disappointments. Expectations from relationships make us suffer. We become very passionate, we get deeply attached and are easily heartbroken.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: *Why Do We Suffer?* | Page 23

Q: How does detachment help us overcome suffering?

A: The ones who rejoice realize that life is an illusion, just like a dream. They know that they are but actors in this cosmic drama and in the end when the curtain is drawn, everything disappears and dissolves. Rather, they live a life of detachment, knowing that in the end the curtain will be drawn and just like a dream, everything will dissolve and disappear.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 6: *Rejoice – Enjoy the Show* | Page 65

Q: Why does the ego's sense of ownership cause suffering?

A: The ego continues to make us suffer as it lives in a world of 'I' ness, 'My' ness and 'Mine' ness. Isn't this ignorance? We clearly see that we come without anything and go without anything. Still, throughout life, we believe that we are the ego and we suffer. By overcoming the ignorance that we are not the ego, the mind or the body we will Suffer No More.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: *Overcoming Ignorance* | Page 59

Q: How does love without expectation lead to freedom from suffering?

A: I have learned to live with love. Because love creates joy – not expectations. Expectations make us miserable, so I don't expect anything in love. I just accept whatever comes my way as a gift from the Divine. Thus, I don't suffer. While my love says, I need you because I love you, their love says, I love you because I need you. Thus, they suffer because when their need is not fulfilled, their love breaks.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Afterword | Page 111

Q: Can we be happy even without wealth and possessions?

A: Have you noticed how the rich live a life of insecurity, wondering how they would survive if they lost their money and wealth? But if we peep out of the windows of the very same villas of the rich and famous, we can see people outside in the world without any of these luxuries. But they don't suffer. They are living a life of laughter and joy, even though they seem to be struggling for their basic needs.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 23

Q: What happens when need turns into greed?

A: The problem arises when we let our need become our greed. And when these desires are unfulfilled, we suffer. We all have needs, we suffer because we let greed take charge of our life. A greedy man says, 'This is mine...but what is yours should also be mine.' Greed rings a bell of misery in our life. We must eliminate it to be happy.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 3: Messengers of Misery | Page 37

Q: Why do we suffer after the death of loved ones?

A: These attachments are not real. We don't belong to anybody. We come alone and we go alone. It is ignorance that made Ram suffer. Everybody has to die one day, but if we react negatively after the death of a dear one, we are choosing to fill our life with misery. We must learn to accept life and move on. To be happy is a choice, so is to be unhappy.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 6: Rejoice – Enjoy the Show | Page 67

Q: Why is the craving for love one of the strongest causes of suffering?

A: One may suffer in love. Expecting love from the one we love and then being disappointed, leads to a common situation called 'heartbreak.' It can devastate an individual, even lead to somebody starting to drink or take drugs. This craving of the heart is one of the strongest emotions known to man and can cause suffering beyond imagination. This is not physical pain - it is heartache.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 1: What Is Suffering? | Page 9

Q: How does dispassion and detachment protect us from heartbreak?

A: Can we avoid suffering of this kind? Of course, we can, but we permit ourselves to drown in disappointments instead of living with dispassion and detachment, all because we think that our relationships will make us happy. The wise ones live life anticipating and being prepared for such heartaches, and thus in a way, they fit their life with shock absorbers that restrict suffering despite the emotional accidents.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 24

Q: How does attachment to the body and mind cause suffering?

A: We suffer because we believe that we are the ego. The ego creates arrogance that wants everything to be 'mine.' It becomes so self-centered in the 'I' and lives believing that this is 'my' house, car, and spouse. All this leads us to suffer when in reality this suffering is not necessary. Because we don't realize the Truth that the ego is an illusion, we continue to suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 21

Q: What is the Buddha's teaching on desire and suffering?

A: The second Noble Truth talks of the cause of suffering primarily being desire or craving which leads to disappointment and misery. The prince saw that although he was living in royalty and luxury, there was pain and suffering everywhere in the kingdom. He found that desire and craving

were the key causes. He realized that we could reduce suffering and even escape from it if we overcome the ignorance that is born from our greed.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 18

Q: Is it possible to live a truly detached life?

A: After all, I have realized the Truth that life too is like a dream, nothing will be mine at the end. So why should I be attached to anything or anybody? These attachments cause suffering and thus, I live a detached life. Because I have made my rascal mind transform from a monkey to a monk – I live in peace. Where there is no peace, there can be no happiness and there is guaranteed suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Afterword | Page 112

Q: Why is it important to choose positive people and relationships?

A: We suffer because of our toxic relationships and strangely enough, such relationships are our choice. If we want to be happy, we can choose to be with positive people who nurture happiness, just as we can stay away from poisonous ones who only fill our life with toxic emotions and make us suffer. We must learn to change if we want to escape from suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 26

Q: How does sitting on our 'nail' of suffering prolong misery?

Aren't some of us like Tom's dog? We sit on a nail and we groan and moan. There are things that make us suffer, but we don't take that suffering out of our lives. Like that dog, we too sit on our suffering – and cry and whine and complain and suffer – but we don't get up and get off that nail – that pain and suffering. Well, it's our choice. You can move away from that nail. You can walk away from the nail. You can leave the suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 96

TOPIC: MEDITATION, MIND AND INNERPEACE

Q: What is the mind's role in creating suffering?

A: We imagine ourselves to be the mind and go through stress and worry. The mind is like a popcorn machine and is constantly producing thoughts. This constant rumbling and mumbling of the mind causes unnecessary suffering which we can put an end to. The mind wonders and wanders but if we realize we are not the mind, we can observe the rascal suffer and laugh at it.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 20

Q: How can meditation help us eliminate suffering?

A: If we analyze the lives of spiritual saints, those who have realized the Truth, they don't suffer. They use techniques like silence and meditation and eliminate all suffering of the mind. Because they are conscious of the Truth, they transcend the ego and experience peace, joy, and bliss. They transcend suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 60

Q: How do we convert the mind from a monkey to a monk?

A: We must reduce our MTR – Mental Thought Rate. And make the mind produce less thoughts. That way, there is less stress and suffering. How do we do it? By watching the mind. It jumps like a monkey from thought to thought. We must watch it. Spend moments in silence. Contemplate a positive thought. We should be still until we convert the mind from a monkey to a monk. We will find the suffering will turn to bliss.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 98

Q: What is the significance of inner silence in ending suffering?

A: We can enjoy our original state of peace if we use our intellect to control our brain activity and not let our thoughts rumble and mumble like a monkey that creates anxiety through its desires, cravings and negative thoughts. Spend moments in silence. Contemplate a positive thought. When we are still, we connect to the observer within — the one who does not suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 61

Q: How does the mind shuttle between past and future causing anxiety?

A: As the mind shuttles from yesterday to tomorrow and swings from the past to the future like a pendulum – it makes us sweat and suffer. But, why must we suffer? We are not the mind. We have a mind that seems to enjoy suffering. But if we realize that we are not the mind – we can just observe the rascal suffer and laugh at it. Because we live in ignorance, thinking we are the mind – we suffer.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 52

Q: What is the brain's role versus the mind's role in suffering?

A: Scientists have tried to define the mind as a product of brain activity. The brain is the hardware and the mind, the software. Each human being is said to have over a hundred billion neurons that fire thoughts and behave like the mind. Just like talking is the function of the mouth and walking is an activity of the legs, thinking is the activity of the brain but attributed to the mind.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 53

Q: How does the intellect differ from the mind and how can it protect us?

A: Our mind is a rascal. There is another part of our mind called the intellect. Separate the two. The mind thinks and makes us suffer. The intellect discriminates and makes us happy. We must put our intellect in charge of our life. We must filter every thought so that we can choose our thoughts, keeping the happy ones, and throwing away the miserable ones.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 97

Q: How do positive emotions replace the messengers of misery?

A: We must reverse it. We must eliminate desire and craving and fill our lives with positive emotions like love and compassion, faith and hope, confidence and courage, forgiveness and peace if we want to be truly happy. Instead of living with fear, worry, hate, anger, jealousy and revenge – I choose to live with faith, hope, love, forgiveness, confidence and courage.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 2: Why Do We Suffer? | Page 26

Q: What is the war within that we must fight to overcome suffering?

A: There is a war within, a war between the mind and the intellect, a war between the ego and the Divine Spirit that blissfully gives life to the body and mind to live. The ego and the mind in the body fight our realization. The realization actually rings the death knell of the Mind and Ego. Therefore, we need to work really hard to defeat the mind and ego if we want to Suffer No More.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Afterword | Page 108

Q: How does prayer and channeling pain into devotion help?

A: This is the ultimate method to eliminate suffering for when we transcend suffering, we sublimate it. We channelize the pain into prayer. We transmute the perceived suffering into a joyous celebration of liberation. Not everybody can do that. But if we want to Suffer No More, we must be aware of the ultimate cannon that can destroy all suffering.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 103

Q: How does the mind's constant thought production create stress?

A: Now that we know that we must make our intellect control our thoughts, we must do one more thing. We must slow down the mind. The mind can produce 50 thoughts a minute – a whopping 50,000 thoughts a day. It is the thoughts that make us suffer. The more the thoughts, the more the stress, the more the suffering. We must reduce our MTR – Mental Thought Rate.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 98

Q: What does it mean to be an intelligent observer of the mind?

A: This may sound strange but it is true. We all talk of a mind that suffers but in reality the mind is an illusion. It does not exist. The moment we overcome this ignorance we become intelligent observers and Suffer No More. Even if our mind wants to suffer, it may choose to do so, but we do not need to accept the suffering of the mind as it is not us.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 5: Overcoming Ignorance | Page 56

Q: How can we overcome negative thoughts before they cause suffering?

A: Don't let your mind go to yesterday. Your mind has this habit. It will think about the sorrows of the past. Stop it, tie it down and replace the thought with the joyous thought of the present. Sing a happy song, watch a happy movie, call a cheerful friend or just go and help somebody. You will see a smile come on your face. When the mind tries to fill suffering gas in your head, you blow out this toxic gas as you have resolved to Suffer No More.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 91

Q: Can we truly achieve inner peace in daily life?

A: If you had a choice, what would you do? Would you prefer to suffer through life or live in joy and peace? Of course, you would prefer to be happy. Who wouldn't? And the good news is that you can. You can choose to be happy for the rest of your life – no matter what. We can live with Joy and Peace. Yes, we can make Suffering Cease, if only every moment we Seize.

Source: **Suffer No More** | Chapter 9: Live in Joy and Peace | Page 89

Q: How does joy shared become joy doubled?

A: I try to share other's suffering just as I share my joy with others. Because I have learned that joy shared is joy doubled and suffering shared is suffering halved. I take other people's suffering and reduce their load. As I throw other peoples suffering into the dustbin, I try to share the bliss I have with them, try to make their world a happier place. After all, the world is a stage and we must enjoy the show before we go.

Source: ***Suffer No More*** | *Afterword* | Page 113